

Cheetah

Acinonyx jubatus

Vulnerable

Fact Sheet · Colouring Page · Activities

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Cheetah — Fact Sheet

Scientific name	Acinonyx jubatus
Conservation status	Vulnerable
Region	Sub-Saharan Africa; small population in Iran
Habitat	Open grasslands and bushy areas in parts of Africa and the Middle East
Diet	Carnivore — gazelles, impalas, wildebeest calves, hares
Weight	21–65 kg
Size	67–94 cm at shoulder
Lifespan	10–12 years in the wild
Wild population	Around 7,000 remaining in the wild

Did You Know?

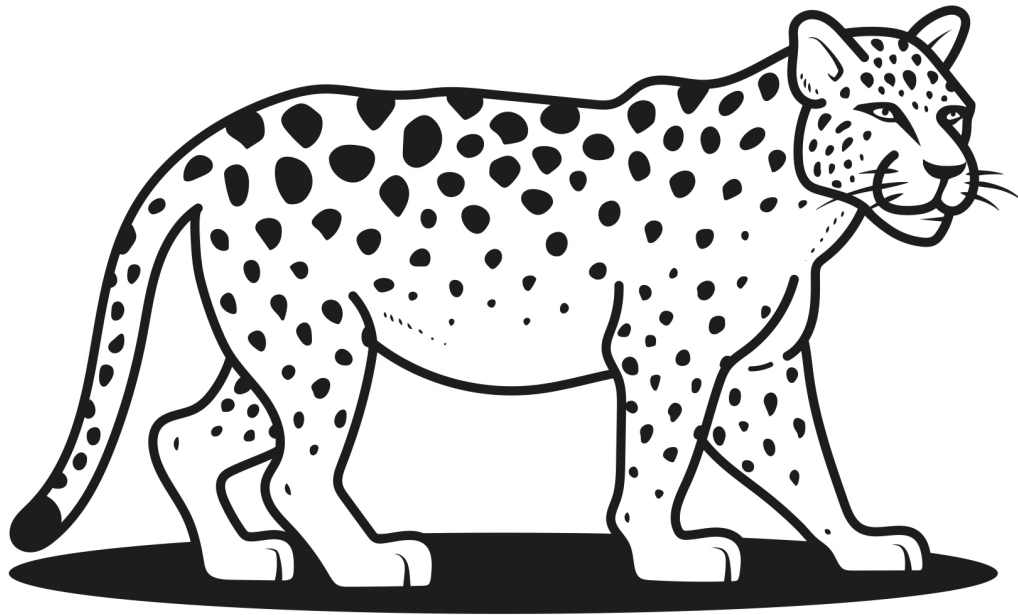
- The cheetah is the fastest land animal on Earth, reaching 112 km/h in just 3 seconds.
- Unlike other big cats, cheetahs cannot roar — instead they chirp, purr, and bark.
- They have solid black spots (not rosettes) and distinctive black 'tear stripes' under each eye.
- A cheetah's claws are semi-retractable — like running spikes — giving extra grip at top speed.
- After a high-speed chase, a cheetah must rest for 30 minutes before it can eat.
- Cheetahs are the only big cat that can turn mid-air at full speed using its tail as a rudder.

Threats to Survival

1. Habitat loss — cheetahs need large territories and suffer from land conversion
2. Human–wildlife conflict — farmers kill cheetahs to protect livestock
3. Illegal wildlife trade — cubs are taken to sell as exotic pets
4. Low genetic diversity making the species fragile

Colour Me: Cheetah

Cheetahs are tawny yellow with solid black spots. Their underside is white; two solid black 'tear stripes' run from eye to mouth.



Cheetah — Activities

Word Search

Find all 8 words hidden in the grid.

K	U	Z	T	B	Y	H	B	M	T	W	W
S	N	V	U	L	N	E	R	A	B	L	E
F	B	U	J	P	U	A	F	R	I	C	A
U	O	J	S	P	R	I	N	T	L	I	S
S	A	Y	G	D	N	E	H	Y	F	Q	P
P	E	L	Y	F	G	Q	D	I	H	I	V
O	U	S	S	U	N	H	N	A	T	U	Y
T	I	Y	I	P	O	G	T	F	T	U	I
S	N	R	N	X	E	E	F	Z	L	O	O
U	G	S	Q	Q	E	E	B	B	A	D	R
U	R	M	U	H	J	A	D	G	G	Z	N
K	J	I	C	S	A	V	A	N	N	A	U

CHEETAH	SPRINT	SAVANNA	VULNERABLE
SPOTS	AFRICA	PREDATOR	SPEED

Match It Up

Draw a line from each word on the left to its meaning on the right.

Cheetah		illegal capture for the pet trade
Tear stripes		black lines under the eyes
Savanna		open grassy African landscape
Conservation		world's fastest land animal
Poaching		work to protect wildlife

Fill in the Blanks

- The cheetah can reach _____ km/h over short distances.
- Cheetahs have solid black _____ on their fur.
- Unlike other big cats, cheetahs cannot _____.
- Cheetahs are found mainly in _____ Africa.

Answers: 112 / spots / roar / Sub-Saharan

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